

Mapping For Success & Laser Focus

All Begins With 4 Questions

- **What do I really want from my life?** You would be amazed how many people never ask themselves this. Some people will have greater clarity on this than others and that's ok but when you are unsure of the best course of action to take it is good to reflect on all the things you think you'd like and chose the one that ties in mostly with your values.
- **What am I willing to give up to get there?** This is the next hurdle on which people trip. They know what they want but they are not willing to give up their highly charged social life which might ruin their chances of success.
- **How will I set my mind to this?** Do you have a plan to ensure that you will mentally stick to this? Pat Spillane used visualisation on the way to football matches to help get him get in the zone. Maybe you will have to get up early to study for example, when you don't feel like it – will you go back to bed? Or, will you picture what it's like when you are receiving your diploma?
- **What's my next action?** Amazingly, some people will get through the first three questions and then not take enough positive and assertive action towards their goals...

4 Spheres

- Think in ink – make sure to write down your goal and use the SMART or OKR goal setting models to help you get there. Fail to plan then you should plan to fail.
 - Like a horse running a race it will help to keep your blinkers on as best as possible. This might mean taking actions like installing social media blocking apps, turning off notifications, locking yourself away for 2-3 hours to get highly focussed work done.
- Have some in-built reviews to assess whether you are still on course towards your goal, do you need help and course correct where necessary.

Mapping For Success Boosters

- It is a good idea to try and keep it to one main goal for each of the four important spheres of your life – family, extracurricular, work and personal. If you neglect any of these spheres over a long period there will be a feeling of imbalance.
- The problem of latent potential in this life is not caused because of a lack of good ideas but that too many good ideas mean that people are spreading themselves too thin.

